AnchorMTM: Supplementary Methods and Protocols

Lele Wang[1,2*] Yu Dong[1,*] Yuxiang Meng[1,2] Guan Li[1,2] Zhe Wang[1,2] Guihua Shan[1,2,3] Jun Liu[1,2†]

S1 Extended Methods and Reproduction Protocol

This companion records the extended construction, feature correspondence and parameter settings used by the main paper. The three result-figure reproduction programs and their numerical verification are supplied in the accompanying source package.

S2 Merge-Tree Map Preliminaries

S2.1 Augmented Merge Trees and Feature Supports

For a sampled 2D or 3D field $f_t : D \to \mathbb{R}$, the merge tree T_t records sublevel-set connectivity: minima create components and saddles join them as the threshold increases. Negating the field gives the split-tree convention. Critical points are supernodes connected by superarcs; augmentation associates regular vertices with these arcs [2, 5, 10]. Extraction and simplification precede layout.

A leaf represents an extremum at spatial location p_i^t. Its feature support S_i^t consists of that extremum and the regular samples on its incident leaf arc, excluding the parent critical sample. It is not the full component or the complete subtree above that arc. For cross-frame overlap, these supports are sets of stable spatial sample IDs: the same ID must denote the same spatial sample across frames. Fixed-grid inputs preserve this identity through consistent sample indexing. Internal arcs retain further regular samples for scalar filling. Write $\mathscr{D}_t(v)$ for the descendant leaf labels of a node v, and $h_t(v)$ for its scalar level. The lowest common ancestor determines the merge-height matrix:

$$V_{ij}^t = h_t(\mathrm{lca}(i,j)), \quad i \neq j; \qquad V_{ii}^t = f_t(p_i^t). \tag{1}$$

Equal-level merge events form one multifurcation; arbitrary binary refinements do not add strict constraints. All subsequent guarantees refer to the supplied, possibly simplified tree.

S2.2 One-Dimensional Merge-Tree Profiles

A 1D merge-tree profile represents extrema at anchors in a selected leaf order. Regular vertices on leaf arcs supply scalar context within leaf intervals; internal arcs and paths to the LCA supply the intervening gaps [2, 5]. In join convention, extrema become profile minima, and the largest profile value between two anchors gives their displayed merge level. Exact preservation requires each strict subtree to occupy a contiguous leaf block. Arranging these profiles along time yields a static temporal map. Figure S1 illustrates sample identities across a tree and its 1D representation. This profile model provides the basis for the spatial anchoring formulation below.

S3 A Common Model for Spatially Anchored Maps

We first describe the coordinate, interval and merge-error constraints shared by temporal merge tree maps. A common formulation then distinguishes the objectives of existing maps from the restrictions imposed by the tree. Analysis uses join convention; split-tree scalar signs are restored after reconstruction.

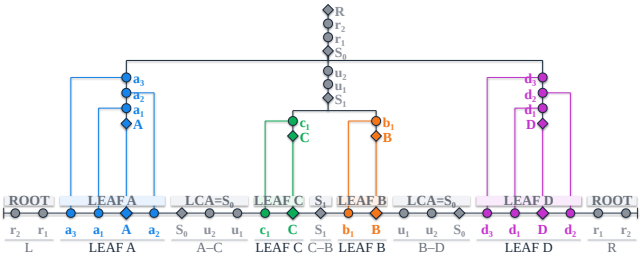


Figure S1: Illustrative mapping of one augmented merge tree to a 1D layout, reproduced directly from the supplied PowerPoint. Colored leaves A–D and regular arc samples retain their identities; arrows connect source-tree samples to their displayed positions. The sample ordering is schematic, not a spatial projection or an optimized experimental result.

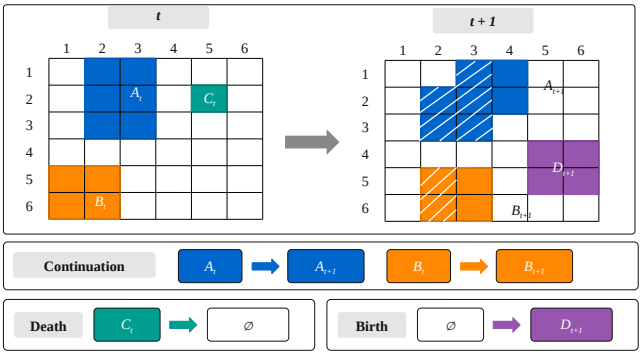


Figure S2: Overlap-based leaf correspondence on a shared grid. Colored regions represent leaf-arc supports; hatching marks samples shared with the previous frame. Maximum-overlap one-to-one assignment continues A and B, leaves C_t unmatched, and assigns a new identity to D_{t+1}. Birth and death denote matching states, not identified physical events.

S3.1 Shared Spatial Reference and Layout Model

Cross-frame Leaf Correspondence. We track merge-tree leaf extrema p_i^t using their leaf-arc supports S_i^t. On a shared fixed grid, overlap-based preprocessing [2] counts common spatial samples:

$$O_{ij}^t = |S_i^t \cap S_j^{t+1}|. \tag{2}$$

Hungarian assignment maximizes total intersection count over one-to-one pairs, discarding zero-overlap pairs. Figure S2 illustrates the resulting identity states.

Continuation inherits a Track ID; *birth/death* starts an unmatched current identity or ends an unmatched previous track. For *non-bijective correspondence*, including potential one-to-many, many-to-one and ambiguous relations, only the assigned one-to-one links are retained. For a current leaf i, $\mu_t(i)$ denotes its valid predecessor. The layout receives precomputed tracks aligned to leaf rows; upstream support and confidence conventions are detailed in Supplementary Material.

These correspondences, computed before any topology-budget sweep, provide the motion samples for Spatial Anchoring, which distinguishes a reference target q_i^t from the display anchor x_i^t. Only valid consecutive-frame matches contribute displacements; failed

*Affiliations: [1] Advanced Interactive Technology and Application Laboratory, Computer Network Information Center, Chinese Academy of Sciences, Beijing, China; [2] University of Chinese Academy of Sciences, Beijing, China; [3] Hangzhou Institute for Advanced Study, UCAS, Hangzhou, China. E-mails: lelewang@cnic.cn; dongyu@cnic.cn; yxmeng@cnic.cn; liguan@sccas.cn; wangzhe@sccas.cn; sgh@sccas.cn; liujun@sccas.cn. Lele Wang and Yu Dong contributed equally to this work. Jun Liu is the corresponding author.

†Corresponding author. E-mail: liujun@sccas.cn.

matches or interrupted tracks contribute no sample for that step. By default, one unit direction $a^* \in \mathbb{R}^d$, $d \in \{2,3\}$, is estimated offline from all matched consecutive-frame extremum displacements:

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta p_i^t &= p_i^t - p_{\mu_t(i)}^{t-1}, \\ S &= \sum_{t,i \text{ matched}} \Delta p_i^t (\Delta p_i^t)^\top, \\ a^* &\in \arg\max_{\|a\|=1} a^\top S a. \end{aligned} \tag{3}$$

The leading eigenvector maximizes squared projected motion. The same calculation serves 2D and 3D; it is performed once for the whole sequence. Its sign makes total signed projected motion nonnegative; for near-zero signed motion, the largest-magnitude component is made positive. With negligible motion energy, the longest domain axis is used (first axis on a tie). Repeated leading eigenvalues leave the maximizing direction nonunique; the reported eigengap indicates this ambiguity. A supplied physical direction may replace a^* without changing the layout. Overlap matching may miss fast-moving features or those with changing or weakly overlapping supports, affecting the displacement sample and hence the estimated direction.

For the selected direction, the minimum and span of the projected domain bounding-box corners define a common origin o and extent $L > 0$. The reference is

$$q_i^t = \langle a^*, p_i^t \rangle - o \in [0, L]. \tag{4}$$

Direction, origin and scale remain fixed across frames and all budgets for the same prepared sequence. Distinct extrema can share projected coordinates while retaining separate identities. Anchoring minimizes constrained deviation rather than requiring $x_i^t = q_i^t$.

Relative geometry uses distances d_{ij}^t between leaf-support centroids. These differ from extremum references because a changing support can move its centroid while the extremum stays fixed. Widths $W_i^t = s m_i^t$ convert positive support measures with a fixed scale s, without per-frame normalization.

For example, consider four minima. The projected order A, C, D, B separates A and B by the C, D subtree, violating the required contiguity of $\{A, B\}$; exact topology therefore cannot realize all four targets without displacement.

With correspondence and the reference fixed, a frame comprises a leaf order, extremum anchors, and a scalar profile:

$$M_t = (\pi_t, x_t, \psi_t), \qquad \psi_t : [0, L] \to \mathbb{R}. \tag{5}$$

We seek reference-aligned positions and motion while approximating relative geometry and controlling displayed topology. The interval-layout set $\mathscr{L}(\pi)$ requires intervals of widths W_i centered at z_i to lie inside the canvas, remain disjoint with gap at least $g \geq 0$, and contain anchors satisfying $|x_i - z_i| \leq \rho W_i/2$, $0 \leq \rho \leq 1$. Infeasible total widths and gaps are reported rather than rescaled.

Actual displacement is $|x_i - q_i|$, normalized by L when reported. To distinguish order conflict from finite-width placement, define

$$\mathrm{NROE}(\pi) = \frac{1}{2L} \max_{j \leq k} [q_{\pi(j)} - q_{\pi(k)}]^+. \tag{6}$$

This is the smallest worst displacement of a nondecreasing point placement, divided by L; it ignores widths. For finite intervals, the exact fixed-order cost is

$$\tau(\pi) = \min_{(x,z) \in \mathscr{L}(\pi)} \|x - q\|_\infty. \tag{7}$$

The minimum is attained whenever the layout set is nonempty. It is evaluated exactly from the fixed-order packing constraints, equivalently through a minimax linear program.

For distinct labels, let V_{ij}^ψ be the maximum profile value between their anchors, with $V_{ii}^\psi = \psi(x_i)$. We require

$$\begin{aligned} d_{\mathrm{top}}(\psi_t, T_t) &= \max_{i,j} |V_{ij}^{\psi_t} - V_{ij}^t| \leq \eta, \\ \eta &= (\varepsilon_0 + \varepsilon)\Delta_F. \end{aligned} \tag{8}$$

Here $\Delta_F > 0$ is the sequence-wide scalar range, ε_0 is a fixed numerical allowance, and $\varepsilon \geq 0$ is the sole primary user control. The implementation defaults to $\varepsilon_0 = 10^{-7}$. NMLE reports the achieved normalized error $d_{\mathrm{top}}/\Delta_F$. Exact topology means zero labelled error on the declared tree.

All remaining settings belong to a fixed configuration Θ_0: position slack β_0, the four objective weights, width scale, gap, anchor slack and output resolution. For a prepared sequence, the default interface is $M_t^\varepsilon = \mathrm{AnchorMTM}(T_t, q_t, W_t, V_t, \mu_t; \varepsilon, \Theta_0)$. Advanced settings may be supplied once, but only ε varies in a budget sweep. Supplementary Material specifies the fixed scale rules and implementation tolerances.

For canonical cophenetic merge-tree representations whose fixed labels cover every leaf and whose induced matrices include the diagonal, d_{top} equals the unnormalized labelled interleaving distance [4, 7]. Under these conditions, $d_B \leq d_I \leq d_{\mathrm{top}}$ [6].

S3.2 Existing Maps as Instances of One Layout Problem

With the model fixed, the methods can be compared through

$$\begin{aligned} &\min_{\pi \in \Pi,\ (x,z) \in \mathscr{L}(\pi)} \lambda_R E_R + \lambda_G E_G + \lambda_M E_M + \lambda_C E_C \\ &\text{s.t. } d_{\mathrm{top}}(\psi, T) \leq \eta. \end{aligned} \tag{9}$$

Here E_R measures squared reference displacement, E_G fits support-centroid distances, E_M fits a matched temporal target $\hat{x}_i$, and E_C penalizes offsets from interval centers. A method selects an order rule Π, placement terms, temporal targets, width semantics and merge allowance.

TMTM packs tree-compatible intervals and aligns subtrees through temporal overlap. ST-MTM uses tree-constrained ordering, relative-distance fitting and temporal position constraints. Both keep exact topology and omit an absolute reference penalty. Projection and curve-rank maps instead prescribe a coordinate without enforcing tree-compatible blocks or the interval model. Consequently, low reference error, low relative-distance stress and exact topology are distinct properties.

S3.3 Where the Spatial Reference Conflicts with the Tree

The four-leaf example isolates the obstruction: a spatially sorted order splits a strict subtree. Keeping the subtree contiguous forces some reference displacement, and finite intervals can force more. How much is unavoidable, which merge causes it, and what allowance releases it? These questions depend on the tree, references, widths and allowance, so the following bounds apply across layout objectives.

S4 The Positional Price of Keeping the Tree

How much must any admissible map deviate from its reference? The following bounds isolate what topology and finite widths make unavoidable: the first answers how much a tree-compatible point order must deviate, the second adds interval packing, and the third asks which restrictions survive a merge-error allowance. The resulting certificates apply independently of the layout algorithm. Full proofs and computational definitions accompany the paper in Supplementary Material. We suppress t within a frame, use $[v]^+ = \max(v, 0)$, and take empty maxima as zero.

S4.1 Exact-Topology Reference-Order Bound

For a reduced tree with strictly increasing proper-ancestor levels, exact topology makes every subtree contiguous. Let $[m_X, M_X]$ be the reference hull of the leaves in subtree X.

Theorem 1 (Exact-Topology Position Bound)**.** *Every zero-error profile has* $\mathrm{NROE}(\pi) \geq \nu^*(T, q)$*, where*

$$\nu^*(T, q) = \frac{1}{2L} \max_{v} \max_{\substack{X, Y \in \mathrm{ch}(v) \\ X \neq Y}} [\min(M_X - m_Y, M_Y - m_X)]^+. \tag{10}$$

Recursive child ordering by reference-hull midpoint attains this point-model order bound in $O(n \log n)$ *time.*

Proof sketch. Sibling blocks must choose one orientation. Their two possible inversion costs are $[M_X - m_Y]^+/2$ and $[M_Y - m_X]^+/2$. Midpoint order chooses the smaller; every inverted leaf pair is separated by sibling blocks at its LCA. □

This result isolates the ordering restriction imposed by the tree and references. Midpoint ordering attains the point-order optimum; finite intervals introduce additional constraints, considered next.

S4.2 Width-Aware Position Bound

Finite widths, minimum gaps, anchor slack and canvas capacity add packing costs to the point-order obstruction. For a nonempty leaf set S, let $H_i = \rho W_i/2$, $\ell_i = q_i - W_i/2 - H_i$, $h_i = q_i + W_i/2 + H_i$, and $s_i = W_i + g$. Define two packing summaries:

$$A(S) = \max_{a\in S}\left(\ell_a + \sum_{\substack{i\in S\\ \ell_i\ge\ell_a}} s_i\right),$$
$$B(S) = \max_{b\in S}\left(\sum_{\substack{i\in S\\ h_i\le h_b}} s_i - h_b\right). \tag{11}$$

The first uses upper reference-endpoint sets and the second lower sets; sorting and cumulative sums evaluate them. For disjoint leaf sets X, Y and the full leaf set $\mathscr{F}$, write

$$\omega(X,Y) = \tfrac{1}{2}\min\{A(X)+B(Y), A(Y)+B(X)\} - \tfrac{g}{2},$$
$$E_\partial = \max\{0, B(\mathscr{F}) - g, A(\mathscr{F}) - g - L\}. \tag{12}$$

Here ω takes the cheaper block orientation and E_∂ accounts for both canvas ends. Let $\mathscr{P}_0$ contain every pair of distinct sibling descendant-leaf sets. The certificate is

$$\mathscr{B}_w(T,q,W) = \max\{E_\partial, \max_{(X,Y)\in\mathscr{P}_0}\omega(X,Y)\}. \tag{13}$$

The dependence on g, ρ and L is through Eqs. 11–12; it is suppressed in the certificate's arguments.

Theorem 2 (Width-Aware Position Bound)**.** *For any feasible exact-topology interval layout,*

$$\|x - q\|_\infty \ge \tau(\pi) \ge \mathscr{B}_w(T,q,W). \tag{14}$$

With zero widths and gaps, $\mathscr{B}_w = Lv^*(T,q)$.

Proof sketch. The first and last anchors of selected leaves must enclose their intervals and intervening gaps, up to the allowed anchor slack. Upper and lower sets in Eq. 11 maximize the resulting shortfall against reference separation. Exact topology requires one orientation of every sibling pair; the canvas ends give the two one-sided costs. □

Thus $\mathscr{B}_w$ bounds all exact-topology legal interval orders and need not be attained; $\tau(\pi)$ is the attained minimum for a specified order. These quantities have coordinate units, whereas NROE and v^* are normalized by L.

S4.3 Bounded-Topology Position Bound

A merge-level allowance can release some contiguous blocks, but still limits interleaving. If leaf k lies between descendants i, j of node u, interval containment gives $V_{ik}^{\Psi} \le V_{ij}^{\Psi}$, hence $V_{ik} \le h(u) + 2\eta$. Define $A_\eta(u)$ as the highest ancestor, including u, with $h(A_\eta(u)) - h(u) \le 2\eta$. This uses the accumulated ancestor-height difference in scalar units, on the reduced equal-level tree with the fixed labels of Eq. 8.

Let $\mathscr{P}_\eta$ consist of two types of leaf-set pairs: $(\mathscr{D}(u), \{k\})$ for every internal node u and leaf $k \notin \mathscr{D}(A_\eta(u))$; and $(\mathscr{D}(u), \mathscr{D}(w))$ for internal nodes u, w satisfying

$$\mathscr{D}(w) \cap \mathscr{D}(A_\eta(u)) = \varnothing,$$
$$\mathscr{D}(u) \cap \mathscr{D}(A_\eta(w)) = \varnothing. \tag{15}$$

For any nonempty leaf set X, use its reference hull $[m_X, M_X]$ and define $\kappa(X,Y) = [\min(M_X - m_Y, M_Y - m_X)]^+/(2L)$. The two certificates are

$$C_\eta(T,q) = \max_{(X,Y)\in\mathscr{P}_\eta}\kappa(X,Y),$$
$$C_{w,\eta}(T,q,W) = \max\{E_\partial, \max_{(X,Y)\in\mathscr{P}_\eta}\omega(X,Y)\}. \tag{16}$$

Theorem 3 (Bounded-Topology Position Bound)**.** *In a profile with $d_{\text{top}} \le \eta$, no leaf outside $\mathscr{D}(A_\eta(u))$ can lie between two leaves of u. Every pair in $\mathscr{P}_\eta$ lies wholly in one block orientation or the other. Consequently,*

$$\mathrm{NROE}(\pi) \ge C_\eta(T,q), \qquad \tau(\pi) \ge C_{w,\eta}(T,q,W), \tag{17}$$

with the second inequality applying to the interval model.

The separation principle excludes interleaving for each eligible pair; the two possible orientations then yield κ and ω. Thus C_η bounds normalized reference-order error, while $C_{w,\eta}$ includes finite-width and boundary costs in coordinate units. Flattening every parent gap at most 2η and applying Theorems 1 and 2 to the remaining tree gives another valid certificate. Neither construction dominates: accumulated gaps can strengthen the chain certificate, whereas flattening also separates pairs of single leaves omitted by $\mathscr{P}_\eta$. The larger of the two valid bounds may be used.

Interpretation. The three bounds distinguish ordering conflicts, finite-width packing and restrictions that remain under a topology allowance. They explain why some reference displacement can persist even after optimization. In the point model, midpoint ordering attains the exact-topology bound; with finite widths, a gap above a lower bound need not be entirely avoidable because the bound itself may be loose.

A gap smaller than twice the allowance can permit interleaving, but does not guarantee that a chosen order is feasible or improves position; the full merge matrix is still checked. The allowance concerns the displayed hierarchy; the source field and feature identities stay fixed. These bounds are reported as benchmarks for unavoidable error; ranking and continuous acceptance use the exact fixed-order evaluations in Section S5.

S5 AnchorMTM: Approaching the Bounds

AnchorMTM instantiates Eq. 9 with a fixed spatial reference and the merge allowance of Eq. 8. The bounds suggest a two-stage construction: choose an admissible order with low fixed-order displacement τ, then optimize spatial and temporal quality within a cap on that displacement. Exact Mode keeps the tree up to the numerical tolerance; Budgeted Mode admits a declared merge-level error. The order search is heuristic, while admission and fixed-order placement are checked explicitly.

S5.1 Leaf Order within the Merge Budget

With features and their reference fixed, construction chooses an order by the lexicographic objective

$$\pi_t^{\varepsilon} \in \arg\min_{\pi\in\mathscr{C}_t(\varepsilon)}\big(\tau_t(\pi), \mathrm{NROE}_t(\pi)\big),$$
$$\text{s.t.} \quad \delta_t^*(\pi) \le \eta(\varepsilon). \tag{18}$$

The finite candidate pool contains the original strict-topology order, midpoint initializations, and orders visited during width-aware refinement of threshold and selective flattenings. Every candidate is evaluated against the same source merge matrix. Selection minimizes τ first and NROE second. Algorithm 1 separates this discrete selection from fixed-order placement.

Candidate generation. *Exact Mode* sets $\eta = 0$ and requires zero labelled merge error on the supplied tree. *Budgeted Mode* permits $\eta > 0$. Setting only the additional budget $\varepsilon = 0$ while retaining $\varepsilon_0 > 0$ gives a numerical allowance, not zero labelled error. Both modes share the same interval model and placement objective.

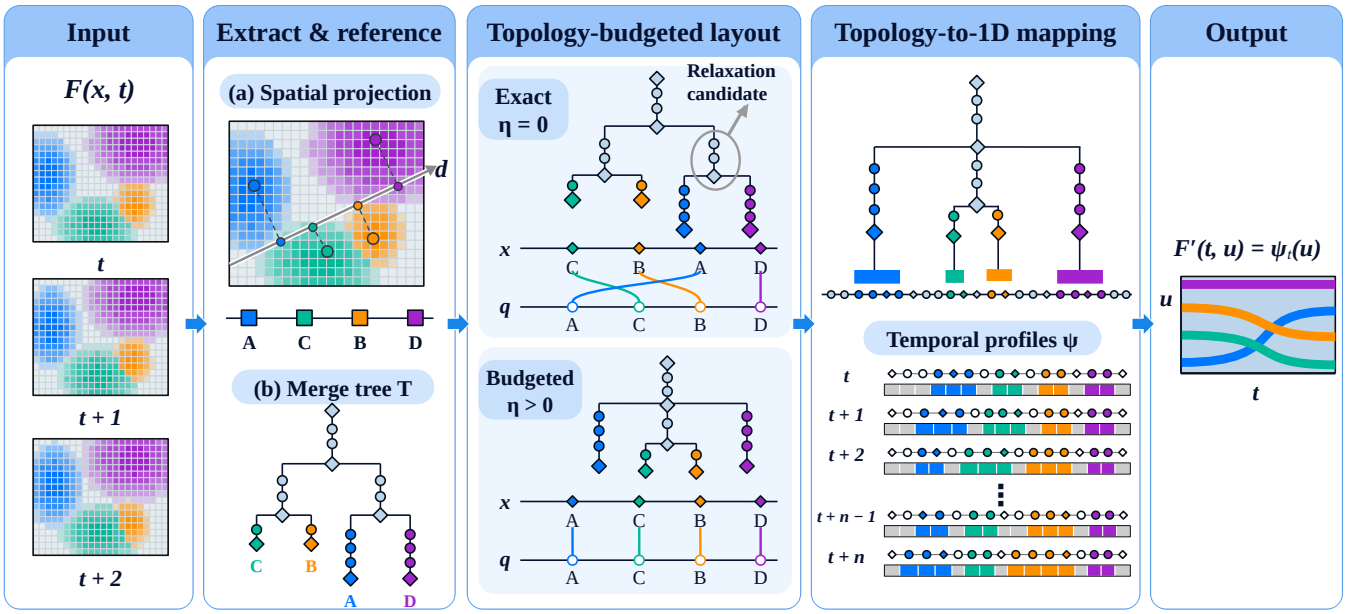


Figure S3: Schematic AnchorMTM workflow: extraction and referencing, topology-budgeted layout, and topology-to-1D reconstruction produce the temporal map. The layout panel combines leaf-order search and anchor placement.

Algorithm 1: Single-Control AnchorMTM

Data: 2D/3D field sequence and grid; $\varepsilon \geq 0$; fixed configuration Θ_0.
Result: Temporal map I^{ε}, error records, or a failure report.
Extract augmented trees, leaf supports and extrema; match supports and assign Track IDs
Estimate one direction and fixed references q_t; reuse this preprocessing across budgets
$\eta \leftarrow (\varepsilon_0 + \varepsilon)\Delta_F$
for *each time step t in temporal order* **do**
  Report and stop if widths and gaps exceed the fixed canvas
  $\mathscr{C}_t \leftarrow \mathrm{GenerateAndRefine}(T_t, q_t, W_t, V_t, \eta)$; retain strict-topology candidates
  Evaluate $\tau(\pi)$, $\mathrm{NROE}(\pi)$ and $\delta^*(\pi)$ for candidates
  $\mathscr{F}_t \leftarrow \{\pi \in \mathscr{C}_t : \delta^*(\pi) \leq \eta\}$
  if $\mathscr{F}_t = \varnothing$ **then** report no feasible candidate and stop
  Select π_t^{ε} from $\mathscr{F}_t$ by (τ, NROE)
  Compute optimal merge barriers for π_t^{ε}
  Solve the four-term QP only for π_t^{ε}, with cap $\tau(\pi_t^{\varepsilon}) + \beta_0$ and valid matched history
  Reconstruct the profile by leaf/LCA filling and barrier correction
  Record candidate counts, continuous and rendered errors, motion and failures; append profile to I^{ε}
return I^{ε} *and diagnostic records*

Candidate generation includes the exact tree, threshold flattenings, and a conflict-driven selective flattening. Midpoint orders initialize these structures. Width-aware block insertion refines the four best initial structures, together with the exact tree, while retaining the point-model budget order as a candidate. Moves improve the lexicographic score consisting of τ and a squared packing-residual term, and must pass $\delta^*(\pi) \leq \eta$. Visited initial and trial orders are retained in the deduplicated pool, including the strict-tree initialization and retained point candidate. Final budget filtering and lexicographic selection use the exact fixed-order costs.

Figure S4 illustrates the additional ordering freedom created by a selective flattening. Removing the A–B sibling constraint admits the order A, C, D, B while retaining the C–D subtree. This structural proposal still requires evaluation against the original merge matrix and the prescribed error budget.

The exact-tree structure remains a refinement seed, and its child-block moves preserve strict topology. Widths, gaps and canvas scale remain fixed throughout the search. Capacity failures, empty admitted sets and numerical solver errors are reported separately.

S5.2 Optimal Merge Barriers and Topological Feasibility

For a fixed order, a pair's displayed merge is the largest intervening barrier. Set $C_k = \min_{i \leq k < j} V_{\pi(i)\pi(j)}$ and $F_k = \max(V_{\pi(k)\pi(k)}, V_{\pi(k+1)\pi(k+1)})$ for gap k.

Proposition 1 (Optimal barriers)**.** *With fixed extremum values in the continuous non-strict model, the smallest labelled merge error is*

$$\delta^*(\pi) = \max\left\{0, \max_k (F_k - C_k), \frac{1}{2}\max_{i<j}\left(V_{\pi(i)\pi(j)} - \max_{i \leq k < j} C_k\right)\right\}, \tag{19}$$

and barriers $b_k = C_k + \delta^*(\pi)$ attain it.

Error δ requires $F_k \leq b_k \leq C_k + \delta$. Choosing the largest admissible barriers satisfies every pair's lower merge requirement exactly when $\delta \geq \delta^*$. Thus the order meets the merge-level allowance in this continuous model exactly when $\delta^*(\pi) \leq \eta$.

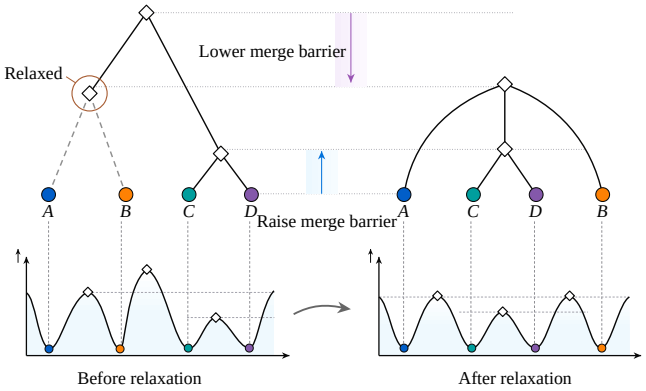


Figure S4: Selective relaxation releases the A,B block constraint and admits order A,C,D,B while retaining the C,D grouping. The accompanying profiles illustrate changed merge barriers; source-level guides show the hierarchy changes. Heights are schematic, and candidate orders still require evaluation against the original merge matrix.

S5.3 Constrained Spatiotemporal Anchor Placement

Once the order is fixed, the core terms are E_R, mean squared deviation from the fixed reference, and E_M, mean squared error in matched projected motion. The auxiliary term E_G approximates support-centroid distances through ordered anchor separations; E_C regularizes anchor offsets from interval centers. All four terms and their nonnegative weights are retained:

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{x_t,z_t} \quad & \lambda_R E_R + \lambda_G E_G + \lambda_M E_M + \lambda_C E_C \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & (x_t, z_t) \in \mathscr{L}(\pi_t), \\ & \|x_t - q_t\|_\infty \le \tau(\pi_t) + \beta_0. \end{aligned} \tag{20}$$

For each valid match, set $\Delta q_i^t = q_i^t - q_{\mu_t(i)}^{t-1}$ and use the previous display anchor plus this reference displacement as the temporal target:

$$\hat{x}_i^t = x_{\mu_t(i)}^{t-1} + (q_i^t - q_{\mu_t(i)}^{t-1}). \tag{21}$$

Thus E_M follows projected motion while favoring continuity of $x-q$. First-frame, newly born and otherwise unmatched leaves have no previous-frame motion penalty. Each term is averaged over its features, ordered pairs or valid matches; the current automatic-reference adapter uses unit confidence for valid matches.

Only ε changes the topology allowance $\eta(\varepsilon)$. The fixed slack $\beta_0 \ge 0$ bounds additional position deviation after ordering. Because $\tau(\pi_t)$ is attained, the cap admits a feasible placement for the selected order. The convex QP balances the four objectives within this cap, processing frames in temporal order.

S5.4 Profile Reconstruction and Error Evaluation

Reconstruction inherits the leaf-arc sampling and LCA-path filling of the merge tree map pipeline [2, 5]. Original extrema remain at their anchors; regular samples provide scalar context within intervals and gaps. Optimal-barrier correction then clips each inter-anchor interior to b_k and raises an existing peak if necessary. This separate correction is required for relaxed orders; inherited LCA filling alone does not enforce the minimax barriers.

A common direction, origin, extent, and pixel conversion are used for all frames. The profiles form the final temporal map,

$$I^\varepsilon(t,u) = \psi_t^\varepsilon(u), \qquad 0 \le u \le L. \tag{22}$$

Strict-extremum clearance and raster rounding can change the achieved error, so the reconstructed profile is evaluated after rendering. Records distinguish the requested allowance, position certificates, attained τ, continuous δ^* and rendered merge error. Raster-capacity and nonfinite-value errors stop reconstruction.

S6 Experimental Configurations

S6.1 Datasets, Baselines and Evaluation Protocol

Our four planar inputs are Gaussian, Ring, Wildfires and Storms (64, 40, 32 and 744 frames). Raster lengths are 4096, except Ring's original 196 positions. The ST-MTM persistence numbers are tested as per-frame range fractions $p = (0.001, 0.001, 0.15, 0.105)$, or $0.1\%, 0.1\%, 15\%, 10.5\%$; all 880 thresholds were checked [2]. Gaussian is a three-peak reconstruction, Ring uses the archived generator, Wildfires aggregates FRP into 32 grids, and Storms uses ERA5 anomalies with the archived moving-mean and smoothing convention. Author-processed arrays are unavailable, so these are disclosed local reconstructions, not identical-input reproductions.

A separate fifth planar input, PM2.5, adds 744 hourly January 2017 fields on a 160×144 interpolation grid. Its shared-input local TMTM, ST-MTM and curve scores are recomputed, with TW $k = 1$ on all frames. The PM2.5 mode labelled Balanced uses the 5% budget fixed from the qualitative case, without validation-set budget selection; both optimization and full-pipeline times are measured without a tree cache. Balanced has the lowest SNS and NPE in this local comparison, while Hilbert has the highest TW.

The volumetric inputs are Cylinder (102 frames, $135 \times 64 \times 48$, Q-criterion) [1, 12] and Tangaroa (201 frames, $300 \times 180 \times 120$, velocity magnitude) [8]. Cylinder computes Q from the original $192 \times 64 \times 48$ velocity grids before cropping; 2% persistence uses each frame's scalar range, followed by one fixed sequence scaling of $-Q$. Tangaroa uses speed clipped to $[0,2]$, replaces near-zero values below 10^{-6} by the archived inflow value 1, and retains absolute persistence 0.2. These preprocessing choices are shared with the local TMTM adapter.

For the volumetric comparison, the reference is restricted to the positive Cartesian axes rather than the continuous direction in Section S3.1. The archived offline rule chooses the axis capturing the most squared displacement of matched support centroids, with a minimum-image correction for Cylinder's periodic z coordinate (period 6); both datasets select $+x$. Centroids select the axis only: placement targets remain leaf extrema projected onto that fixed axis and full-domain range. The stored layout configurations are exploratory selections; Table S2 reports their different weights and budgets.

Within each local dataset, methods share source trees, identities and geometry inputs, and NPE uses one common offline extremum reference and projected range. SNS measures squared scale-normalized stress between support-centroid and anchor distances [2,9]; TW measures neighborhoods [11], with $k = (1,3,5,3)$ and $0 < k < n_t/2$. Ineligible frames are omitted. Absolute anchoring uses

$$\mathrm{NPE} = \frac{1}{T}\sum_t \frac{\max_i |x_i^t - q_i^t|}{L_{world}}. \tag{23}$$

For Gaussian, Ring, Wildfires and Storms, TMTM/ST-MTM SNS/TW are quoted from ST-MTM Table 1 (Temporal mode); their NPE is measured with local adapters and shared references. All PM2.5 and volumetric entries are recomputed locally. The main paper's planar comparison table distinguishes these sources. Local TW coverage is 64/64, 1/40, 4/32 and 11/744; author coverage is unspecified.

Hilbert and Morton provide sample-domain baselines [3]. Their grid orientation is fixed (x columns, y rows), with no rotation, reflection or reversal search. Curves use power-of-two padding, discard out-of-domain samples, and map each extremum's full-grid rank to the common canvas at the original raster length. They impose neither merge-tree topology nor finite-width constraints.

Mode selection. For the four planar datasets, Exact uses $\varepsilon = 0$. Balanced selects a positive budget from 1–10% (1% steps) on the first chronological quarter. Among legal reconstructions with attained $\mathrm{NMLE}_{\max} \le \varepsilon$, it minimizes

$$J = 0.5\,\mathrm{NPE}_{norm} + 0.5\,\mathrm{SNS}_{norm}. \tag{24}$$

Terms are min–max normalized over legal candidates; constant terms contribute zero. Within 0.01 of the minimum, smaller budgets then attained errors break ties. Budgets are frozen before full

Table S1: Planar parameter settings and runtime (seconds).

Parameter	Gaussian	Ring	Wildfires	Storms	PM2.5
ε	1%	1%	5%	10%	5%
N_r	4096	196	4096	4096	4096
s_w	0.00581	0.00328	0.00053	0.01170	0.00073
t_{opt}	0.156	0.150	3.324	2.600	199.975
t_{total}	1.340	0.486	4.424	63.447	231.177

Weights $(4,1,0.5,0.1)$ and $\rho = 0.5$ are fixed. s_w is width per support measure; N_r is raster length. PM2.5 uses $p = 5\%$ of per-frame range and a fixed 5% Balanced budget, without validation-set selection; both times are remeasured without a tree cache under the same pipeline scope. Times are one run on Apple M4: optimization and full pipeline, respectively.

Table S2: Volumetric datasets and Balanced-mode parameter settings.

Parameter	Cylinder	Tangaroa
Frames	102	201
Grid	$135 \times 64 \times 48$	$300 \times 180 \times 120$
Scalar	Q-criterion	Speed $\|\mathbf{v}\|$
Persistence	2% per-frame range	0.2 absolute
Reference	$+x$	$+x$
ε	1%	33.33%
N_r	32768	131072
s_w	2.70668×10^{-5}	0.40953
Weights	$(0.1,16,0,0.1)$	$(0,64,0,0)$
ρ	1	1
Gap/L_{world}	1/300	1/960
Extra/L_{world}	0.1	0.1

Weights are reference, geometry, temporal and eccentricity. s_w is width per support measure (Cylinder voxel counts; Tangaroa physical volume); N_r is raster length, distinct from the physical canvas extent L_{world}. Exact uses zero allowance with the same other parameters as its Balanced counterpart.

runs. Full results include validation frames, and earlier exploratory outputs were observed; this is not an independent held-out test.

S7 Recomputed Figure Data

The controlled-tree program solves a separate minimax LP for every permutation, repeats the width-aware order search and compares both with the certificates. It also compares the recomputed values with all 43 stored overlap and 364 stored budget records.

For the two volumes, the program verifies feature IDs and source merge matrices against the local baseline input; checks interval capacity, anchor slack and gaps; and reconstructs every displayed pairwise merge from the original raster columns. It remeasures 1,515 frame–budget columns and 44,785 feature observations. Baseline reflection is selected by feature-pooled absolute displacement. The label "mean" is the pooled feature mean; NPE is the mean of the per-frame maximum displacement.

For Ring, Storms and PM2.5, the program recomputes per-frame displacement from the saved rendered anchors and the fixed reference, verifies continuous/raster checks and redraws all box plots and merge-error scatters. The 9,168 frame–budget observations include all six PM2.5 budgets. The added PM2.5 2% solve uses a certified alternative solver for one numerically failed QP; objective, constraints and budget stay fixed. Its KKT certificate is supplied with the experiment records.

The volume figure configuration uses default weights $(4,1,0.5,0.1)$, anchor slack $\rho = 0.5$, a motion-derived reference for Tangaroa and streamwise x for Cylinder. Table configurations instead use the fixed x references and the weights reported above. The figure program keeps these configuration identifiers in its output CSVs.

S8 Additional Results

This section collects results that support the paper but are not needed to follow its argument: the controlled four-leaf validation of the bounds, a Ring study that varies spatial guidance together with the merge budget, and an hourly PM2.5 pollution episode.

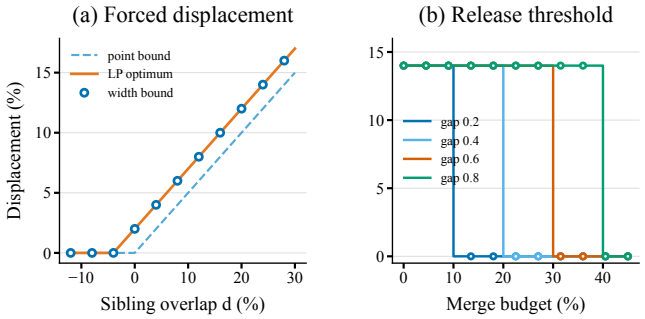


Figure S5: Independent four-leaf validation. (a) The width-aware bound and order search coincide with exhaustive minimax LPs over 24 orders. (b) For four parent gaps, the displacement disappears when twice the merge allowance reaches that gap. Circles mark the recomputed bounds.

Table S3: Current planar sequences: Exact orders attaining the width-aware lower bound, and the share of local baseline point-order error above the exact point bound. Orientations match the primary measurements.

Dataset	Frames	Width hits	TMTM excess	ST-MTM excess
Gaussian	64	64	100.0%	100.0%
Ring	40	40	64.5%	25.7%
Wildfires	32	31	92.5%	98.1%
Storms	744	729	91.0%	83.0%
PM2.5	744	471	56.4%	59.7%

Table S4: Volumetric comparison with a fixed x reference. Bold/underline mark best/second distinct values per dataset; ties share emphasis.

Dataset	TMTM			AnchorMTM (ours)			
	SNS↓	TW↑	NPE↓	Mode	SNS↓	TW↑	NPE↓
Cylinder	0.2956	<u>0.8017</u>	0.4769	Exact	<u>0.1226</u>	0.8010	<u>0.1773</u>
				Balanced	**0.0329**	**0.9117**	**0.0458**
Tangaroa	0.5255	0.6701	0.3866	Exact	<u>0.1204</u>	<u>0.8213</u>	<u>0.1285</u>
				Balanced	**0.1124**	**0.8408**	**0.0653**

All values are local measurements, including adapted TMTM. TW uses $k = 1$, with coverage 102/102 and 201/201. Mode applies only to AnchorMTM. Configurations are frozen exploratory results, not a blind test; settings appear in the supplement.

S8.1 Controlled Four-Leaf Trees

S8.2 Ring: Guidance and Budget

Figure S6 varies guidance jointly with budget: $q_{layout} = (1-\alpha)q_{mid} + \alpha q_{physical}$, with $\alpha = \varepsilon/20\%$ and a fixed $-128.7°$ physical direction. Increasing guidance moves the ring toward its projected positions; the snapshots connect this change to expansion and strengthening.

S8.3 An Hourly PM2.5 Episode

Figure S7 places a 133-hour event within the complete January sequence. Join trees of negated concentration represent high-concentration features, and the display restores positive concentration. The 5% mode attains 4.998% maximum merge error across all 744 hours. Snapshots provide the geographic context for the matched peak visible in the temporal map.

S8.4 Bound Attainment and Forced Error per Sequence

Table S3 lists, for the five planar sequences, the frames on which the selected Exact order attains the width-aware bound and the share of the baseline order error that lies above the exact-topology bound v^*. The shares are computed as $1 - \sum_t v_t^* / \sum_t \mathrm{NROE}(\pi_t)$ from the recorded anchors of each baseline, in the orientation of the primary measurements.

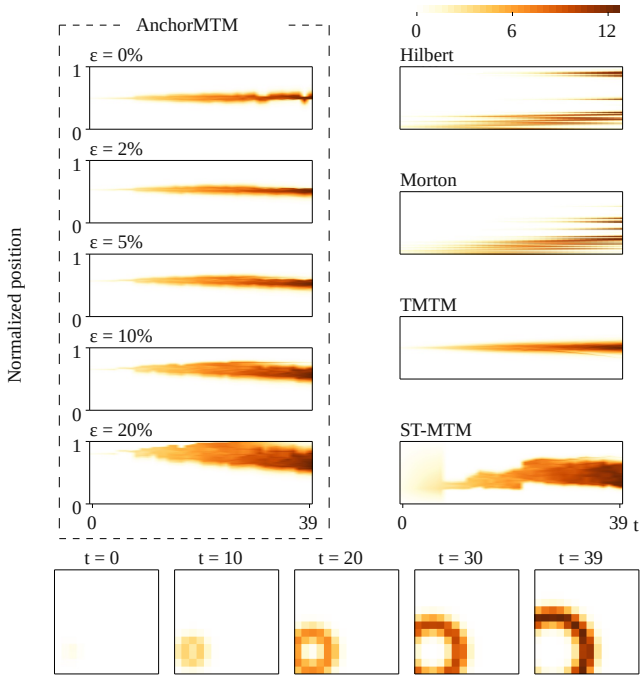


Figure S6: Ring: joint spatial guidance and merge allowances 0, 2, 5, 10 and 20%, with same-input TMTM/ST-MTM maps, supplied curve panels and five source snapshots. All computed maps retain 40 frames and 196 positions.

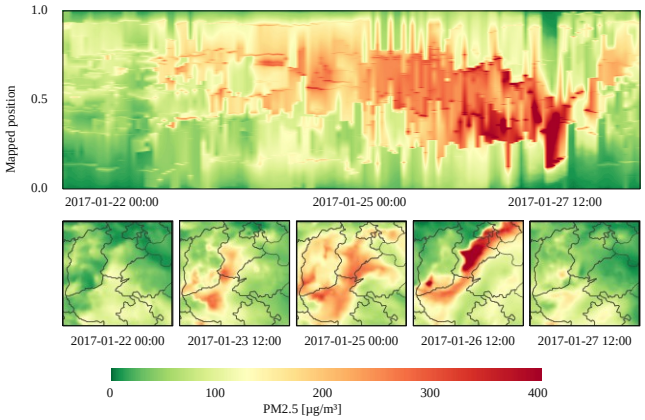


Figure S7: Hourly PM2.5, January 22 00:00–27 12:00, 2017 (Beijing time): the 5% map and five source snapshots. All 133 hourly samples are retained; concentrations above 400 $\mu g/m^3$ saturate.

S8.5 Volumetric Comparison with a Fixed Axis

S8.6 Cylinder: Three Maps of the Same Window

Figure S8 places the central-tree map of the paper next to TMTM and ST-MTM on the same input. The stages of the wake appear in both tree-ordered maps, so they are a property of the hierarchy rather than of the guidance; what the anchored default configuration adds is the streamwise position of each vortex (the paper's volume figure).

S8.7 PM2.5: Three Maps of the Same Episode

Figure S9 compares the three maps of the pollution episode. All three show the build-up from 23 January and the peak on 26 January. In TMTM the polluted bands stay in the middle of the axis; in AnchorMTM they spread over the positions of the polluted areas along the reference direction, and the strongest maxima descend on the map on 26 January as the pollution belt moves toward lower reference positions.

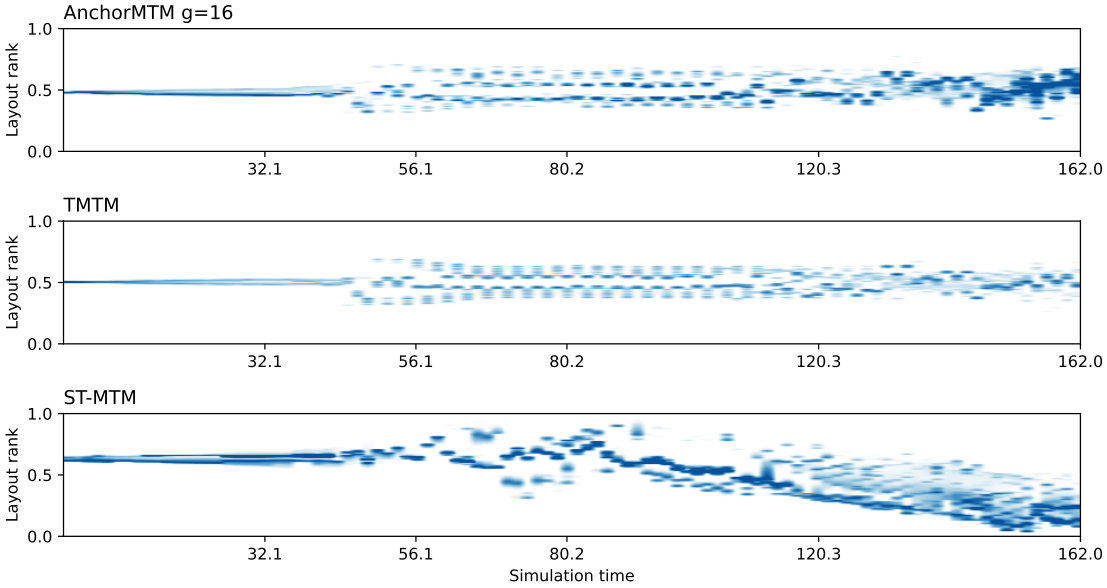


Figure S8: Cylinder, all 102 frames, drawn by the central-tree variant of AnchorMTM ($g = 16$), TMTM and ST-MTM on the same simplified trees. The five stages of the paper's Cylinder figure are visible in both tree-ordered maps; ST-MTM spreads the vortices by relative distance. Each map keeps its own native layout coordinate.

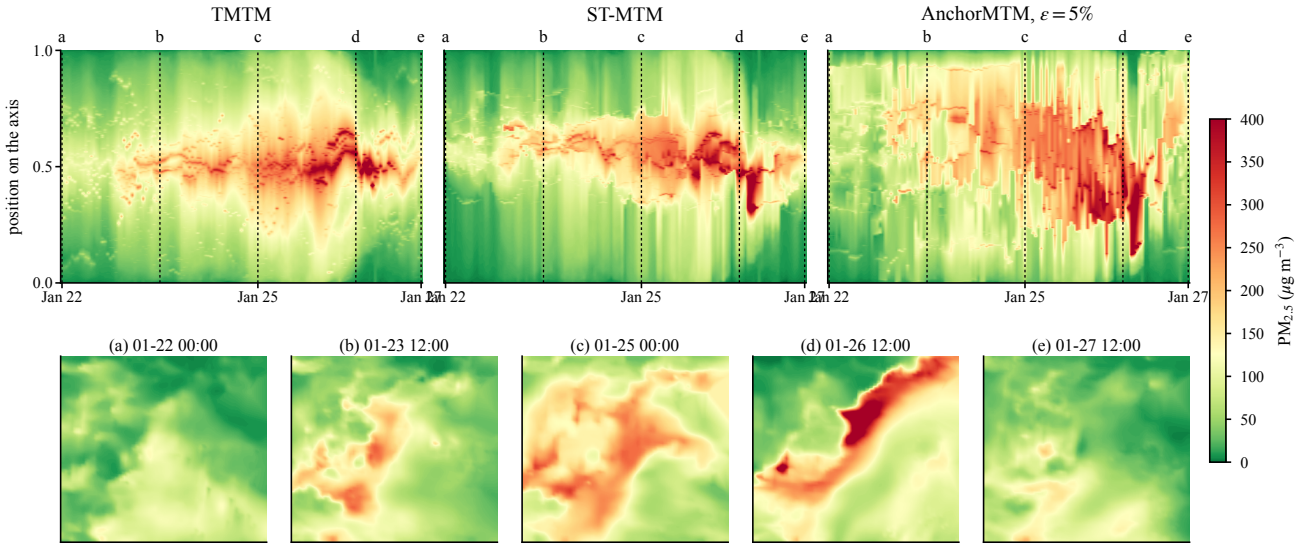


Figure S9: The hourly PM2.5 episode of Fig. S7, 22–27 January 2017, drawn by TMTM, ST-MTM and AnchorMTM ($\varepsilon = 5\%$) on one colour scale; dashed lines a–e mark the snapshot times below. TMTM and ST-MTM are rebuilt with their original configurations; their anchors match the stored table runs frame by frame.

References

[1] S. Camarri, M.-V. Salvetti, M. Buffoni, and A. Iollo. Simulation of the three-dimensional flow around a square cylinder between parallel walls at moderate Reynolds numbers. In *XVII Congresso di Meccanica Teorica ed Applicata*, 2005. 5

[2] M. Diaz, J. Heredia, N. Ferreira, and J. Poco. Spatiotemporal merge tree maps: A topology and geometry aware visualization for temporal scalar data, 2026. Preprint, SSRN 6604235. doi: 10.2139/ssrn.6604235 1, 5

[3] M. Franke, H. Martin, S. Koch, and K. Kurzhals. Visual analysis of spatio-temporal phenomena with 1D projections. *Computer Graphics Forum*, 40(3):335–347, June 2021. doi: 10.1111/cgf.14311 5

[4] E. Gasparovic, E. Munch, S. Oudot, K. Turner, B. Wang, and Y. Wang. Intrinsic interleaving distance for merge trees. *La Matematica*, 4(1):40–65, 2025. doi: 10.1007/s44007-024-00143-9 2

[5] W. Köpp and T. Weinkauf. Temporal merge tree maps: A topology-based static visualization for temporal scalar data. *IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics*, 29(1):1157–1167, Jan. 2023. doi: 10.1109/tvcg.2022.3209387 1, 5

[6] D. Morozov, K. Beketayev, and G. H. Weber. Interleaving distance between merge trees. https://mrzv.org/publications/interleaving-distance-merge-trees/, 2013. Manuscript presented at TopoInVis. 2

[7] E. Munch and A. Stefanou. The ℓ^∞-cophenetic metric for phylogenetic trees as an interleaving distance. In *Research in Data Science*, pp. 109–127. Springer, Cham, Switzerland, 2019. doi: 10.1007/978-3-030-11566-1_5 2

[8] S. Popinet, M. Smith, and C. Stevens. Experimental and numerical study of the turbulence characteristics of airflow around a research vessel. *Journal of Atmospheric and Oceanic Technology*, 21(10):1575–1589, 2004. doi: 10.1175/1520-0426(2004)021<1575:EANSOT>2.0.CO;2 5

[9] K. Smelser, K. Gunaratne, J. Miller, and S. Kobourov. How scale breaks "normalized stress" and KL divergence: Rethinking quality metrics. arXiv:2510.08660, 2025. doi: 10.48550/arXiv.2510.08660 5

[10] J. Tierny, G. Favelier, J. A. Levine, C. Gueunet, and M. Michaux. The Topology ToolKit. *IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics*, 24(1):832–842, 2018. doi: 10.1109/TVCG.2017.2743938 1

[11] J. Venna and S. Kaski. Neighborhood preservation in nonlinear projection methods: An experimental study. In *Proc. ICANN*, vol. 2130 of *LNCS*, pp. 485–491. Springer, Berlin, Germany, 2001. doi: 10.1007/3-540-44668-0_68 5

[12] T. Weinkauf. 3D flow around a confined square cylinder. Public uniformly resampled simulation dataset. Accessed 22 October 2026. 5